

Lesson plan - Three steps to make your podcast

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Age of students:	15-19
Total duration:	4-5 hours (can be divided into several shorter lessons)
Skills:	Informational Literacy ☒ Media Literacy ☒ Creative skills ☒ Digital Literacy: ☒

Objectives: Students will learn how to **create a podcast** and how to **work with Audacity**, a free, open source, cross-platform audio software.

Steps:

First step

You have to record sounds of something, your voice reading a text, a conversation, a story about Golem, to your mobile phone and then to upload it into your computer in MP3 format. You can use the USB cable or some online services like Google disc. I hope you have headphones, if not, we can lend them to you.

Second step

You don't have to use music in your podcast, but I think it would be more pleasant if you do it. You are not allowed to use just any music you find on the Internet. There are laws you have to follow. You can choose only music and sounds which are free to download and to use in your podcast. Here you have a simple option: <https://www.youtube.com/audiolibrary/music> You have to look for some music you would like to have as a background of your podcast.

You have to log to your Google account. After choosing the music, you download it to your computer in MP3 format. It will download to Disc C, in the folder Downloaded Files. Of course, there are many other options like <https://www.bensound.com/royalty-free-music> or <https://freesound.org>

Third step

You will work with Audacity that is a free and open-source digital audio editor and recording application software. You will go to the computer rooms to work on your podcasts. Each team will work on its podcast that should be 2-5 minutes long, not shorter, not longer.

Opening the programme

Find the icon of Audacity on your desktop area. It has blue headphones and yellow sound waves

squashed to each other.

Changing the language

You can change the language setting: Edit - Settings - Surface - Language.

Import the recording

File - Import - Audio (Import your audio recording to Audacity project)

Effects

You can include some effects to your podcast, but it is not necessary, It is just for fun. Let's have a look at some of them.

Echo

If you want to make a step back, use Edit and Undo.

Reverse

Your recording will be played in reverse, from the end to the start.

You can also change the tempo (speed) or pitch (frequency) or both of them.

If you don't like the deep tones in your recording, you can use High Pass Filter.

Two modes of work

You will work in two modes: **Selection Tool**, in which you can mark a part of the track, cut the track (Cut, Trim Audio, Silence Audio), use effects etc. and **Time Shift Tool**, in which you can move part of the track forward or backward. You will switch between these two modes very often.

Noise Reduction

Mark the beginning of the recording (the place without speaking).

Effects - Noise Reduction - Get Noise Profile

Then mark all the recording and again Effects - Noise Reduction - OK

Cutting the record

In the Selection Tool you split the track into several parts.

Edit - Clip Boundaries - Split

In the Time Shifting Tool you can check you are able to move with the parts.

Removal of parts of the track

In the Selection Tool you mark the parts of the track you don't want to be there. Then you can use key Delete or button Cut. There is an option to remove a part of the track and replace it with silence - in this case you use the button Silence Audio.

Import the music

File - Import - Audio

The music is automatically imported into the second track. You can set the volume of each track independently.

Adjustment of the music track

There are many options of how to adjust the music track, I can offer you three of them. Of course you can do it in your own way.

First option

You can let the music track as it is, only with the volume reduced. You can select only some part of the music track and remove the other. You should move the parts of the recording track so that the length of both tracks is comparable and the gaps between them are comparable as well.

Second option

You can choose and select only a part of the music track (which you like best) and remove the rest. Mark the beginning of the part and use the tool Fade In (Effects - Fade In), then mark the ending of the part and use the tool Fade Out (Effects - Fade Out). Mark all the prepared part and copy it as many times as you need (to fill the gaps between parts of the recording track and to put it to the end. In the Time Shift Tool move the parts of both tracks so that they connect to each other and so that they coincide subtly.

Third option

Mark the music track, press Control C and paste it into the third track. Tracks - Add New - Stereo Track. It is necessary that both music tracks are precisely below each other. In the third track reduce the volume. In the second track remove the parts that correspond with the parts of the first track - not using Delete or Cut, but Audio Silence. The result is that the background music is very silent while speaking, but it is stronger in the gaps.

Saving the project and exporting audio

If you have finished all the processing, you have to save your Audacity project (File - Save Project As...). This file can be edited in Audacity again. If you can have your podcast and play it for example on your phone, you have to export it into some audio format (for example MP3). (File - Export Audio...)

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This work is licensed under a Creative Commons Attribution 4.0 International License. ~~Ways to learn spellings~~

• ~~Look, cover, write and check~~

- ~~Find words within the word (there's a 'hen' in 'when!')~~
- ~~Break the word up into sounds (th a nk)~~
- ~~Break the word up into syllables (Fri + day)~~
- ~~Make up a silly sentence/ mnemonic using the letters (big elephants cause accidents under small elephants spells 'because')~~
- ~~Find a word that rhymes with it: is the spelling the same?~~

~~**Writing & Fine Motor Practice**—you can do the old stand by and write your words on a piece of paper, maybe even the dreaded 5x each or you can.....~~

~~1. **Play Dough Words**—use play dough to form letters to spell out each word.~~

~~2. **Pipe Cleaner Words**—use pipe cleaners and bend and form to make letters used to write out the words.~~

~~3. **Yarn Words**—supply some yarn and scissors and let kids snip and create letters to spell out the words.~~

~~4. **Stamp It!**—use alphabet stamps and ink pads to stamp out words or let child use fingerprints to write words if you don't have letter stamps.~~

~~5. **Paint It!**—use a paintbrush and paint to spell words.~~

~~6. **Type It!**—let them type their spelling words on the computer/ipad/laptop.~~

~~7. **Rainbow Words**—spell words using different colored markers or crayons for each sound.~~

~~8. **Salt/Sand/Flour Tray**—spell words using finger or paintbrush (great sensory experience too).~~

~~9. **Trace**—have fun and let kids trace their words on your back or palm. Have them focus on properly forming each letter so you can feel it being drawn.~~

~~10. **Outside Chalk (or Paint)**—go outside and spell your words using big chalk. Just taking the spelling practice outside makes it more fun for kids.~~

~~11. **Shaving Cream**—This is another fun sensory experience. Make a thin layer of shaving cream on a tray and use a paintbrush or better yet a fingertip to spell out the words. Have some napkins on hand~~

~~12. **Trace in the Air**—watch as children trace the letters in the air to spell each word.~~

~~13. **Alphabet Blocks**—use ABC blocks to spell words~~

~~14. **Letter Tiles**—spell words using letter tiles~~

~~15. **Build a Word with Legos**—using some tape write the letters needed for each word ahead of time on some legos. Mix them up and then call out a word and have child(ren) build it using the appropriate~~

~~legos and you will end up with some spelling word towers. Now that's a fun way to spell.~~

~~16. Crayon Bits~~—use your broken crayons to make letters and spell the target words.

~~17. Magnet Letters~~—Take a cookie sheet or head for the fridge, add some magnetic letters and spell out the words.

~~18. Glue & Glitter~~—Write out spelling words in glue and sprinkle some glitter on top. Glitter makes everything fun, doesn't it?

~~19. Hidden Spelling Words~~—on a white piece of paper let your child write out the spelling words using a white crayon. Once all words have been written use watercolors and paint to make hidden words appear.

~~20. Paint (or Hair Gel) Bags~~—Pour paint into a ziplock freezer bag and seal. Use fingertips to write words on bag. To erase, simply squish bag and you are ready for the next word.

~~21. Alpha Bit Spelling~~—Use Alpha Bit cereal, alphabet pasta or even alphabet cookies to spell words—this can even double as a snack when done reviewing if you use the cereal or cookies.

~~22. Print Words~~—Use newspaper or magazine print to cut out fun letters. Have child make words using clipped letters.

~~23. Alphabet Cookie Cutters~~—use ABC cookie cutters to make words. For extra fun, go ahead and make some word cookies.

~~24. Window Writing~~—use Crayola Window Markers and write words on windows or sliding glass doors. They wash off easily and writing on windows or doors is so much more fun than boring old paper.

~~25. Flashlight Words~~—set up an Alphabet chart, turn out the lights and use a flashlight to shine on each letter (one letter at a time) to spell words.

~~26. Craft Stick Spelling~~—write the necessary letters on craft sticks, mix them up and have child build words using the appropriate sticks.

~~27. Shower Spelling~~—Yes, more spelling fun in the tub. This time spread some shaving cream on your shower door or tiled wall over the tub and let your child(ren) finger write words.

~~28. Penny or Coin Spelling~~—use pennies or other small coins to make letters and spell out words.

~~Oral Practice~~—sure you can just practice spelling your words out loud but wouldn't it be more fun to.....

~~29. Sing~~—Use whatever song or beat you like but a simple B I N G O like song & some clapping works wonders especially on that first day of practicing words. It really helps kids begin to remember those words.

~~30. Rap~~ — Yes rap! This is so much fun and a great way to S to the P to the E to the Double L, spells SPELL! Let them have fun with it and get creative.

~~31. Partner Spell~~ — take turns adding a letter to spell each word. For example, for the word FUN— child starts by saying the letter F, parents adds letter U and child then completes word by adding the letter N. This requires focus and listening.

~~32. Record~~ — use a tape recorder to record child(ren) orally spelling words.

~~33. Make a Video~~ — use the household video camera or even your phone to take some quick video of your child spelling the target words.

~~Gross Motor Practice~~ — we like to make spelling practice fun by getting active while practicing our words.

~~34. Jump Rope~~ while orally spelling the words.

~~35. Hula Hoop~~ and spell words out loud.

~~36. Hopscotch Spelling~~ — Write letters outside in chalk or play indoors with large letter cards on floor. Hop from letter to letter to spell words.

~~37. Swat & Spell~~ — put letter cards on the floor and using a flyswatter, swat the letters in the order necessary to spell words.

~~38. Hop & Spell~~ — hop on one foot as you spell words, this is a great exercise in balance especially with longer words.

~~Games and Online Fun~~ — you can use flashcards or you can take your spelling practice to a whole new level by playing games and even having some online fun.

~~39. Have child spell and write 2 sets of words onto flashcards and then play a Memory Game with them.~~

~~40. Which is Correct?~~ Write words on dry erase board and include misspelled words. Have child identify the correctly spelled words.

~~41. Wordsearch~~ — you can visit sites like [PuzzleMaker](#), plug in your child's spelling list and create a word search that you can print. Then have your child search for the correctly spelled spelling words and circle them.

~~42. Mystery Letters~~ — write words with missing letters. Child must figure out which mystery letters are missing in order to complete words.

~~43. Unscramble~~ — use magnet letters or letter tiles for each word, scramble them up and have child put letters in correct order to spell words.

~~I hope you are able to get some new ideas from this list
& make spelling *fun* rather than tedious and boring!~~